Fahan Parish Newsletter

Deaths

Your prayers are asked for
Gemma Whoriskey, 477 Moness Cottages, Burt and Pauline Doyle (nee Doherty) Umricam, Buncrana
We pray for their family and friends saddened by their loss.

Throwing Open the Doors to Christ Novena

This year's Novena begins next Sunday 25 October at 7pm in St Mary's Church, Cockhill. For the nine Sundays before Christmas we will gather for one hour and the ceremony will comprise of the Rosary, a talk given by an invited speaker, the Novena prayer and petitions (which can be placed in a box at the door of the church), a Eucharistic Healing Ceremony and finishing with Benediction of the Most Blessed Sacrament. Once again, the theme of this year's Novena is "Throwing Open the Doors to Christ" – taken from the homily of Pope St John Paul II at the Opening Mass of his Pontificate on 22 October 1978. The first Guest speaker on the opening night will be Bishop Michael Router. All are very welcome. Please come along, bring your families and make the most of this opportunity for prayer as we approach the season of Christ's birth.
(The Holy Hour each Sunday evening in St Mary's Oratory will cease for the moment, resuming after Christmas.)

Adoration in St Mura's Parish Church on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome.
Altar Servers We are recruiting new altar servers so any pupil currently in 3rd Class or older, and who have made their First Holy Communion are welcome to apply. Forms are available from the schools.
Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting 20 October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.
A Weekend Like No other Catholic Marriage Encounter Weekend St. Mary's, Knock, Co. Mayo Friday 9th to Sunday 11th April 2027 This residential Weekend starts at 7.30pm on Friday and finishes at 4.30pm on Sunday, and is open to all married couples. Online booking only at www.marriageencounter.ie
Community Drop In Fahan Presbyterian Church Hall Tooban 2nd & 4th Mondays of the month
Burt Bingo every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm.
Burt's Big Bingo on Sunday 18th October at 3pm in St. Mary's Hall, Burt. Two top prizes of €100. All other lines and houses are €25 and €50 respectively, except for the 9th page which is €50 for the line and €100 for the house. The sheet is €25 for the line and €100 for the house. Book is €12 and sheet €2 Great raffle prizes throughout the bingo. Proceeds to Parish Funds.
Burt GAA Lotto 16-17-18-21-23 Deirdre Mc Gowan €100 Burnfoot.
Beginners Line Dancing Class at St Mary's Hall, Burt Thursdays 7:45pm-8:45pm.
St Vincent De Paul Current and new 3rd level students in need of financial assistance please contact St Mura's SVP on 0860549976 or any member. SVP may be able to help.
Marys Meals: If you have any old notes or coins that you wish to donate to Mary's Meals they can be dropped off to McKenna's Londis, Buncrana on Friday 31st Oct between 9.30am-5.30pm. Otherwise collection can be arranged by contacting Eilis on 087 7060457 or Eimear on 083 3004188.
Patsy Cavanaghs Book "Between the loaning and the lane " will be launched by Daniel O Donnell in McGrorys Culdaff at 3pm this Sunday. All are welcome to attend an evening of song and story.
Samaritans Helpline number Call Free phone: **116 123,** Text: **087 2 60 9090.**
Now Doc Phone Number: 0818400911. Have your Eircode handy.

Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura's Church and St Aengus' are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

Weekly Collection Burt €1386 Inch €333 Fahan €855 ***Sincere Thanks***	fahanparish@derrydiocese.org www.fahanparish.com **18th October 2026** **Twenty Ninth Sunday In Ordinary Time** **Mission Sunday**	**Fr Bradley 9363455** **Fr Baker 9360151** **Parish Office 9360151** (Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)

Mass Schedule

St. Aengus' Burt
(churchservices.tv/burt)
Monday 19th October Mass at 10am
Saturday 24th October Mass at 6.30pm
Sunday 25th October Mass at 10.15am
John and Mary Friel Anniversary Mass

Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch
Sunday 25th October Mass at 9am

St Mura's Church, Fahan
(churchservices.tv/fahan)
Wednesday 21st October No 7pm Mass
Friday 23rd October No 10am Mass
Sunday 25th October Mass at 11:30am
Kathleen McDaid Month Mind Mass
Peter Doherty 4th Anniversary Mass

Chapel Of Ease, Fahan
Thursday 22nd October Mass at 10am

Please note there will be no 7pm Mass on Wednesday 21st October and no 10am Mass on Friday 23rd October in St Mura's Parish Church, Fahan

Bishop Michael Router at Father Hegarty's Rock

Only three weeks after his installation as Bishop of Derry, The Most Reverend Michael Router paid a pastoral visit last Sunday to the parishes of Burt, Inch & Fahan and Desertegney & Lower Fahan (Buncrana). We were delighted to have him amongst us on what was an unseasonably warm and sunny day, for what was a spectacularly wonderful occasion. He walked with us on a Synodal walk from the Stone Jug and celebrated Mass on Father Hegarty's Rock, before returning then to Cockhill Parish Hall for tea and refreshments.
The turnout was splendid, the welcome warm, the support immense and the faith tangible. In the midst of a sometimes stiff Atlantic breeze he joked about not being blown into the water, seemingly perched as he was on the edge of the Lough. But from there he commanded a great view of the gathering and the Statue of Friar Seamus Hegarty OP – and he offered a most memorable Mass recalling the courage and hope which Father Hegarty had in abundance, and asking God to grant us the same gifts for the challenges in our own time. The music and singing were outstanding and the joy and contentment of those gathered there, of all ages, was clear to be seen. After visiting Father Walsh in his home, the bishop returned to Derry with a spring in his step and firm in the knowledge that he will always be welcome in these parts. It was a truly wonderful occasion made possible only by the devotion and help of huge teams of people: our stewards and volunteers, choirs and musicians, farmers and bakers, schools and Parents' Associations (especially at St Oran's NS), and to all who came to celebrate. To them all and to God himself, we must always be thankful.

Father Bradley

Prayer for Vocations

St Paul could have written this passage from today's Second Reading to our seminarians and to the men discerning their vocation: "We know, brothers, that God loves you and that you have been chosen, because when we brought the Good News to you, it came to you not only as words, but as power and the Holy Spirit and as utter conviction."

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or **Garda Síochána,** Buncrana 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or **TUSLA Family & Child Agency** 07491 02233